



| NIGERIAN PEOPLES AND CULTURE



REORIENTATION STRATEGIES

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

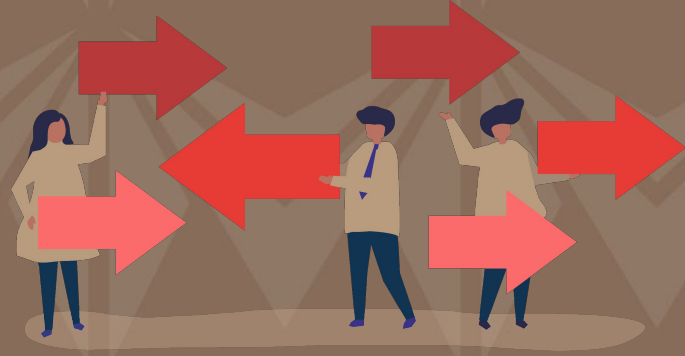
- Define the concept of orientation strategies.
- Examine the different orientation strategies of the Nigerian government.
- Demonstrate to what extent the strategies have achieved their objectives.





INTRODUCTION

Reorientation strategies refer to government authorities, institutions, or programmes aimed at reshaping or redirecting people's attitudes, beliefs, or behaviours towards a particular purpose or set of ideals. To promote good change, these organisations often participate in activities such as public awareness campaigns, educational programmes, skill development, counselling, and community outreach.





INTRODUCTION

In Nigeria, there are several agencies and institutions that are involved in reorientation efforts aimed at promoting positive values, attitudes, and behaviour among the citizens.





REORIENTATION STRATEGIES IN NIGERIA

The different reorientation efforts that will be discussed herewith include the following:

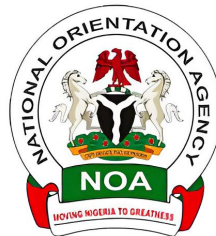
- National Orientation Agency (NOA)
- Operation Feed the Nation
- Austerity Measures
- War Against Indiscipline
- War Against Indiscipline and Corruption
- Mass Mobilisation for Self-reliance, Social Justice and Economic Recovery (MAMSER)





NATIONAL ORIENTATION AGENCIES (NOA)

The National Orientation Agency (which is the successor of the Directorate for Social Mobilisation – MAMSER) was established by Decree 100 of 1993.



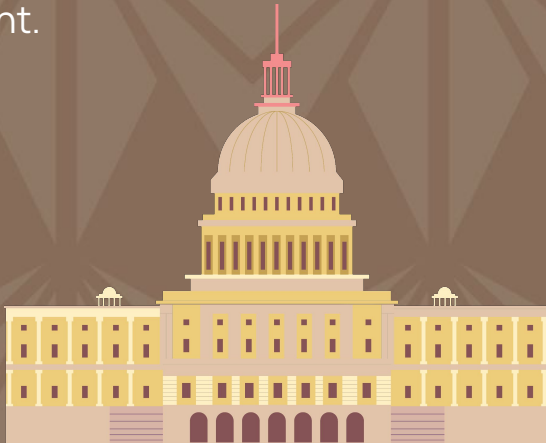
**NATIONAL
ORIENTATION
AGENCY**



NATIONAL ORIENTATION AGENCIES (NOA)

It is a government agency established to create and sustain public awareness, understanding, and support for government policies, programmes, and initiatives.

It was founded with the mandate to reorient Nigerians towards embracing positive values, patriotism, national unity, and development.





NATIONAL ORIENTATION AGENCIES (NOA) - CONTINUED

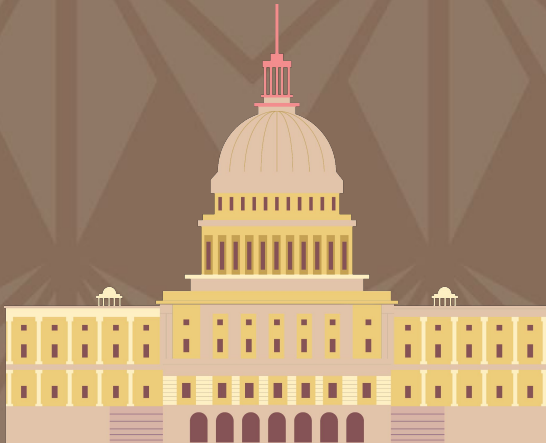
The NOA has embarked on series of orientation programmes in the past that has had significant impact on the people of Nigeria. They include:

- Nationwide Attitudinal Reorientation Programme for Students in Tertiary Institutions
- Implementation of National Ethics and Integrity Policy (Secondary Schools)
- Campaign Against Open Defecation



NATIONAL ORIENTATION AGENCIES (NOA) - CONTINUED

- Building a People of Peace (Inter-Faith Peaceful Coexistence)
- Nationwide Sensitisation on the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA)
- Sensitisation on COVID-19
- Sensitisation on Routine Immunization
- Change Begins With Me: Patronise Made in Nigeria Products and Services





OPERATION FEED THE NATION

Operation Feed the Nation (OFN) was an agricultural initiative launched in Nigeria in 1976-80. It was introduced by the military government of General Olusegun Obasanjo with the aim of addressing the country's food security challenges and reducing dependence on food imports.

Urban dwellers were encouraged to garden undeveloped building plots.





OPERATION FEED THE NATION

The programme involved awareness campaigns, training programmes, and the provision of inputs such as improved seeds, fertilizers, and farm implements to farmers. The need for sustainable agricultural practices and the conservation of natural resources was stressed.



OPERATION FEED THE NATION (CONTINUED)

Some programmes under the OFN include:

- Agricultural Development Project -ADP (1976)
- Agricultural Credit Guarantee Scheme - ACGS (1977)
- River Basin Development Programme-RBDA (1978)
- Rural Banking System-RBS (1978)
- Green Revolution - GR (1980)
- Directorate for Food, Roads, and Rural Infrastructure - DFRR (1986).





OPERATION FEED THE NATION (CONTINUED)

- ❑ The resources (seedlings, insecticides, tractors) were not provided as promised.
- ❑ Activities were not effectively performed.
- ❑ Farmers were sceptical of new methods and administrative officials did not do the job expected of them.
- ❑ The manpower needed to expand farming operations did not materialise.

Although Operation Feed the Nation did not completely achieve its objectives, it played a significant role in raising awareness about agriculture and food production in Nigeria. It laid the foundation for subsequent agricultural development programs and policies in the country.



AUSTERITY MEASURES IN NIGERIA

Austerity measures are strict, frugal economic policies used by the government to manage public debt. These measures are typically undertaken during periods of economic hardship or budget deficits.



AUSTERITY MEASURES IN NIGERIA

- ❑ Austerity measures were introduced in Nigeria after the oil boom of the 1970s, during Buhari's military regime.
- ❑ Structural Adjustment Programme of Babaginda also introduced austerity.
- ❑ From 2015, the government also began austerity measures to plug budget deficit arising from low oil prices and low oil output.

Here are some examples of austerity measures implemented in Nigeria:

1. Fiscal consolidation
2. Reduction of recurrent expenditure
3. Subsidy reforms
4. Revenue diversification
5. Debt management
6. Rationalisation of subsidies and social programs



AUSTERITY MEASURES IN NIGERIA

There are three main types: higher taxes (revenue generation) to fund government spending, revenue generation plus lower government spending, and lower taxes plus lower government spending.

Types of Austerity

Raising taxes to fund spending

Raising taxes and cutting spending

Lower taxes and lower government spending



AUSTERITY MEASURES IN NIGERIA

Austerity measures has continually failed because the government has not addressed the issue of waste in government and lower government spending. The bulk of the burden of austerity is often shifted to the masses to carry.



MID-LESSON QUESTIONS

Which Nigerian leader introduced austerity measures in response to economic challenges during their respective terms?

- A) Buhari
- B) Babaginda
- C) Goodluck Jonathan
- D) Obasanjo



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Which Nigerian leader introduced austerity measures in response to economic challenges during their respective terms?

- A) Buhari
- B) Babaginda**
- C) Goodluck Jonathan
- D) Obasanjo

Austerity measures were introduced in Nigeria during the military regime of Babaginda. While Buhari's military regime in the 1980s also implemented austerity measures, it was specifically under Babaginda's Structural Adjustment Programme (SAP) that these measures were further developed and implemented.



WAR AGAINST INDISCIPLINE

The WAI was a mass mobilisation programme organised by the military dictatorship of Buhari with the aim of correcting social maladjustments. The campaign aimed to instill discipline, moral values, and a sense of national pride among Nigerians. It promoted principles such as punctuality, respect for queues, environmental cleanliness, and adherence to traffic regulations.





WAR AGAINST INDISCIPLINE

The WAI campaign involved public sensitisation, enforcement of discipline through penalties, and public works projects to improve infrastructure and cleanliness.



WAR AGAINST INDISCIPLINE

The WAI achieved remarkable success as the WAI Brigade were quick to deal decisively with anyone who fails to act in accordance with the dictates of the state. What determined the success of the initiative was also its utmost criticism, which had to do with the high handedness of the WAI Brigade. The programme ended in September 1985.



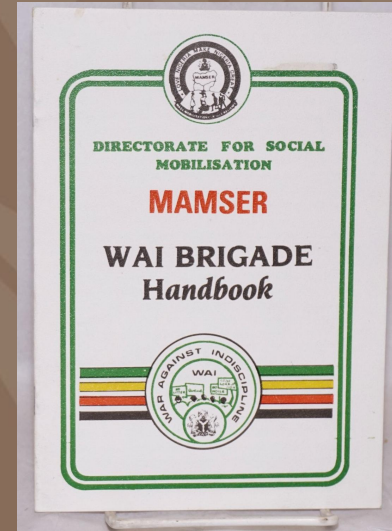
MASS MOBILISATION FOR SELF-RELIANCE, SOCIAL JUSTICE AND ECONOMIC RECOVERY (MAMSER)

It was an initiative launched by the Nigerian government in 1987 following the recommendation of the Public Bureau headed by Samuel Cookey. The primary goal of MAMSER was to mobilise and empower Nigerians to actively participate in nation-building, promote self-reliance, achieve social justice, and drive economic recovery.



MASS MOBILISATION FOR SELF-RELIANCE, SOCIAL JUSTICE AND ECONOMIC RECOVERY (MAMSER)

MAMSER played a key role in the emergence of cooperative societies playing key role in the Nigerian workplace.





MASS MOBILISATION FOR SELF-RELIANCE, SOCIAL JUSTICE AND ECONOMIC RECOVERY (MAMSER)

MAMSER was eventually phased out, and its functions and activities were absorbed into other government agencies and initiatives. While MAMSER had its strengths in promoting self-reliance, social justice, and economic recovery, its overall effectiveness and long-term impact have been a subject of analysis and discussion.



SUMMARY



CONCLUSION

Reorientation strategies have often failed in Nigeria because of corruption, lack of political will, poor leadership, exemplary leadership, improper planning, etc.

There is a need for a declaration of a state of emergence on reorientating Nigerians on the values of trust, sycophancy, legitimate work and moral conscience.



REFERENCES

1. J. B. Denen, Value Reorientation and National Development in Nigeria: The Role of Art Education, BSUJEM, vol. 2, no. 1 (2020).



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THANK
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